# One-page checklist for exam week

## Understand it

In the last week, do not learn anything new. Review the patterns you already know and make them automatic.

Your aim on exam day is accuracy and calm. A simple sentence that is correct is better than a complex one that is wrong.

## The rules

- Task 2: introduction (paraphrase + position), 2 body paragraphs (point, reason, example), conclusion (restate). At least 250 words.
- Task 1: paraphrase + overview + 2 detail paragraphs. At least 150 words. Compare, do not list.
- Before submitting: tense, agreement, articles, spelling, punctuation, linking words, word count.
- Speaking: answer, reason, example. Do not memorize. If you make a mistake, correct it calmly and keep going.

## All the words and forms you need

| | |
|---|---|
| **Task 2 shape** | introduction (paraphrase + position) · body 1 · body 2 · conclusion |
| **Task 1 shape** | paraphrase · overview · detail 1 · detail 2 |
| **Speaking pattern** | answer · reason · example · (feeling) |
| **Final check list** | tense · agreement · articles · plurals · spelling · punctuation · word count |

## Where you use it

**Writing:** Use this page the evening before, then stop studying.

**Speaking:** Smile, speak slowly, and extend every answer by one sentence.

**Reading:** Read the question first, then the text.

## More examples

- In my view, the advantages of online learning outweigh the disadvantages.
- Overall, car ownership rose while bus use fell.
- I'd say I prefer the countryside, mainly because it is quieter. For example, ...
- All things considered, governments should invest more in public transport.
- The most noticeable trend is the steady rise in online sales.
- To be honest, I've never thought about that, but I suppose ...

## Common mistakes

| WRONG | RIGHT |
| --- | --- |
| ✗ Rewriting the question word for word. | ✓ Paraphrase the question in your own words. |
| ✗ Listing every number in Task 1. | ✓ Select and compare the key figures. |
| ✗ Giving one-word answers in Speaking. | ✓ Answer + reason + example. |

## Speaking practice: answer using this grammar

1. Answer three Part 1 questions about your home in the full pattern.
2. Talk for 2 minutes about a skill you want to learn.
3. What changes would make your city better?
4. Do you think technology helps us learn?
5. Describe your perfect weekend.

## Writing practice

Plan (do not write) two Task 2 essays in 5 minutes each.

## Practice

1. Paraphrase: Some people think children should start school early.

2. What goes in a Task 1 overview?

3. How long should Task 2 be?

4. How many body paragraphs?

5. What do you do in Part 1 after the answer?

6. What do you do after a mistake in Speaking?

## Answers

1. It is believed by some that children ought to begin school at a young age.
2. The main trends or the main differences, without figures.
3. At least 250 words.
4. Usually two (or three).
5. Give a reason and an example.
6. Correct it calmly and continue.